

Microlearning

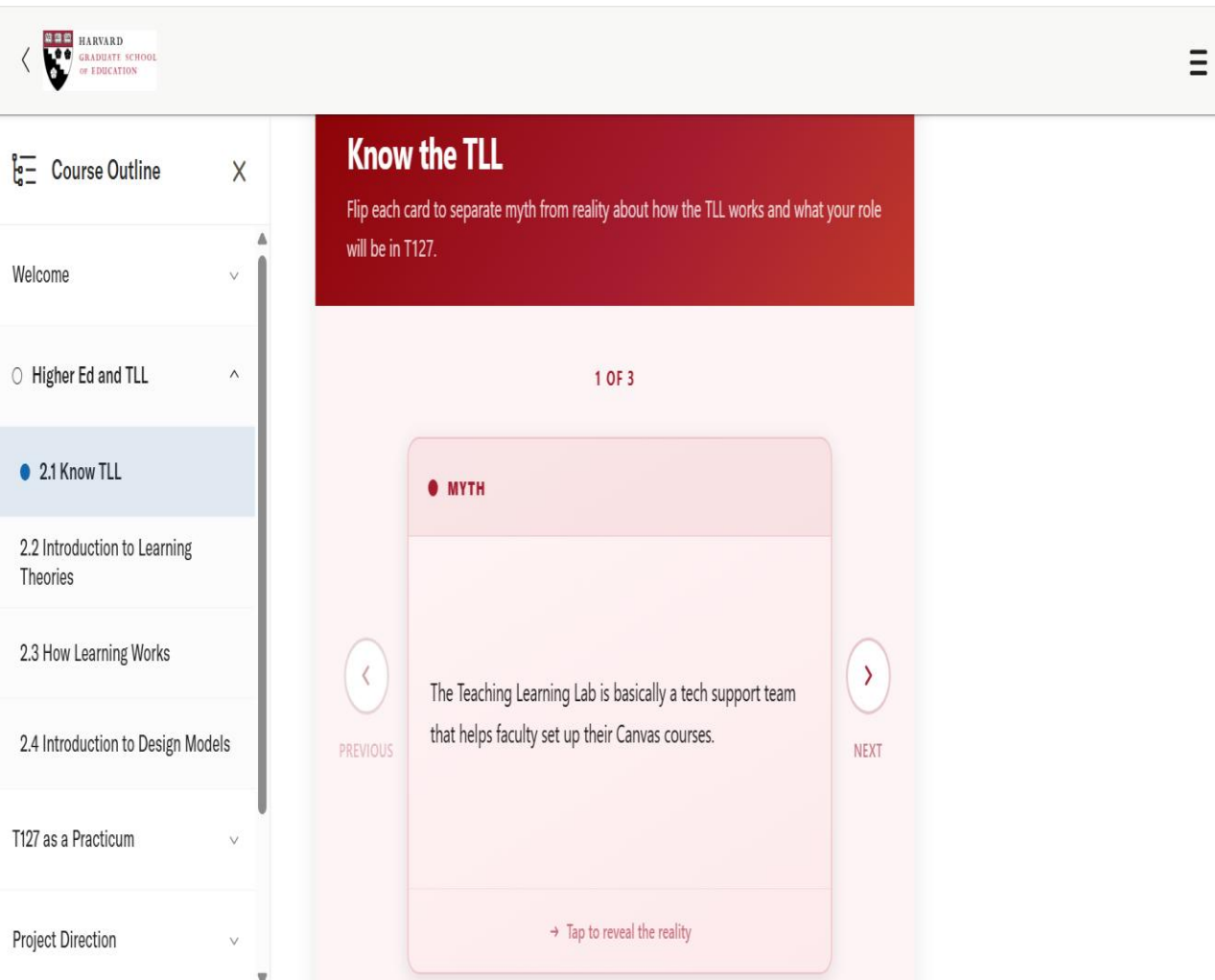
Higher Ed & Portfolio

Capstone Product

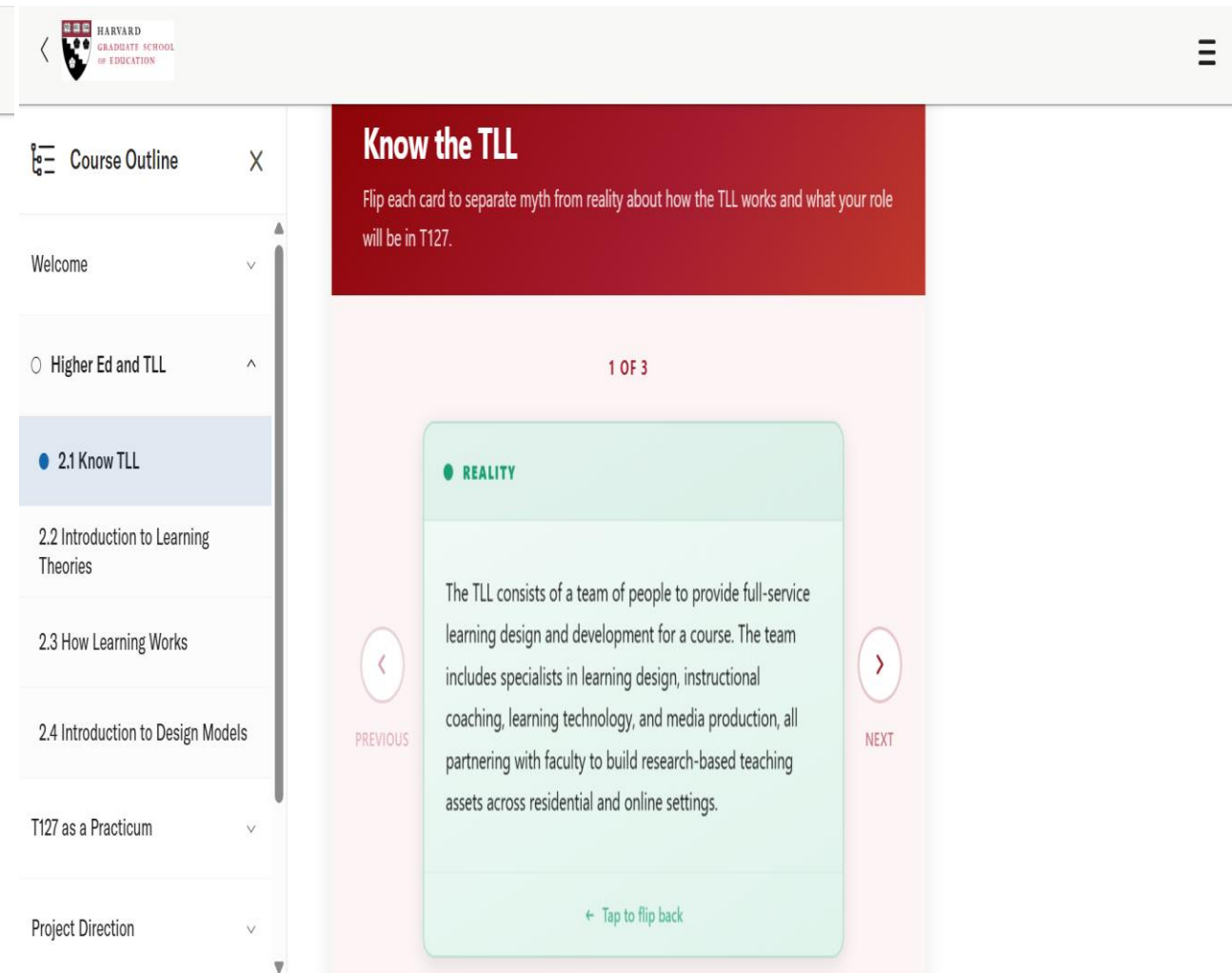
Anitha Manikandan

Know the TLL, Myth and Reality Flip Cards

Before: Myth side



After: Reality side



Introduction to Learning Theories

Before

This screenshot shows the 'Before' state of the course interface. The top header features the Harvard Graduate School of Education logo on the left and a hamburger menu icon on the right. A sidebar on the left contains a 'Course Outline' section with a list of course items: '2.1 Know TLL', '2.2 Introduction to Learning Theories' (highlighted with a blue dot), '2.3 How Learning Works', '2.4 Introduction to Design Models', 'T127 as a Practicum', 'Project Direction', 'Portfolio Planning', and 'Looking ahead to T127'. The main content area displays a red header for 'ACTIVITY 2 · 15 MIN' titled 'How Learning Works', with the subtitle 'Part 1 of 3: Learning Theories'. Below this, a text box explains that every design decision is grounded in theory and that three theories have shaped instructional design since the 1950s. A red button labeled 'Explore the three theories >' is positioned at the bottom of this text box.

After

This screenshot shows the 'After' state of the course interface. The layout is similar to the 'Before' state, but with several enhancements. The sidebar remains the same. The main content area's red header for 'ACTIVITY 2 · 15 MIN' titled 'How Learning Works' (Part 1 of 3: Learning Theories) now includes a 'Hide theories >' button at the bottom left. To the right of the main text box, three new interactive boxes have been added: 'BEHAVIORISM' (Learning through response), 'COGNITIVISM' (Learning through mental structure), and 'CONSTRUCTIVISM' (Learning through doing). Each of these boxes has a dropdown arrow on its right side.

Introduction to Learning Theories

Top

Course Outline

Higher Ed and TLL

2.1 Know TLL

2.2 Introduction to Learning Theories

2.3 How Learning Works

2.4 Introduction to Design Models

T127 as a Practicum

Project Direction

Portfolio Planning

Looking ahead to T127

shaped instructional design since the 1950s, and you will encounter all three during your time with the TLL.

COGNITIVISM

Learning through mental structure

CONSTRUCTIVISM

Learning through doing

Hide theories

The key insight for you as a designer

No single theory is always the right answer. The question to start asking is: what kind of learning is actually needed here? If someone needs to memorize a process, behaviorism helps. If they need to understand a concept, cognitivism helps. If they need to apply judgment in a real situation, constructivism helps. In T127, you will draw on all three.

CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

A faculty member wants students to practice giving feedback to peers on their writing drafts. Which learning theory best supports this design decision?

Bottom

HARVARD GRADUATE SCHOOL OF EDUCATION

Course Outline

2.1 Know TLL

2.2 Introduction to Learning Theories

2.3 How Learning Works

2.4 Introduction to Design Models

T127 as a Practicum

Project Direction

Portfolio Planning

Looking ahead to T127

their writing drafts. Which learning theory best supports this design decision?

A Behaviorism, because feedback is core to reinforcing behavior

B Cognitivism, because students need to connect new feedback skills to prior knowledge

C Constructivism, because students build judgment by actively engaging with real writing in context

D None of these, because peer feedback is not covered by classical learning theories

Complete Page

Back To Top

How Learning Works

Top

Course Outline

Higher Ed and TLL

2.1 Know TLL

2.2 Introduction to Learning Theories

2.3 How Learning Works

2.4 Introduction to Design Models

T127 as a Practicum

Project Direction

Portfolio Planning

Looking ahead to T127

ACTIVITY 2 · 15 MIN

How Learning Works

Part 2 of 3: Novice to Expert

NOVICE

EXPERT

NOVICE

BEGINNER

COMPETENT

PROFICIENT

EXPERT

What it tells you

Novices store knowledge as isolated facts. Experts store it as interconnected patterns. A novice approaching a new problem searches slowly for a rule. An expert immediately sees structure and connections. They do not just know

What you do with it

Design for where the learner actually is, not where you wish they were. Novices need clear structure, worked examples, and explicit connections. Open-ended exploration is something experts thrive in. For novices, that same ambiguity overwhelms and

Bottom

Course Outline

Higher Ed and TLL

2.1 Know TLL

2.2 Introduction to Learning Theories

2.3 How Learning Works

2.4 Introduction to Design Models

T127 as a Practicum

Project Direction

Portfolio Planning

Looking ahead to T127

• CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

A faculty partner gives you a syllabus with 12 dense readings in week one and says "students should figure out the key themes themselves." As a learning designer, your first concern is:

A The readings may be too long for the time available

B Novice learners need structure and explicit connections, not open-ended discovery this early

C The faculty member should choose the themes themselves before class

D Students at HGSE are advanced enough to handle unstructured learning

How Learning Works

more. They actually think differently.

slows learning down.

Course Outline

○ Higher Ed and TLL

2.1 Know TLL

2.2 Introduction to Learning Theories

● 2.3 How Learning Works

2.4 Introduction to Design Models

T127 as a Practicum

Project Direction

Portfolio Planning

Looking ahead to T127

The faculty challenge: the curse of expertise

Faculty are domain experts, but expertise comes with a hidden cost: the longer you know something deeply, the harder it becomes to remember what it felt like to not know it. This is the curse of expertise. Faculty often design courses for learners who think like they do, not for the novices actually in front of them. As a learning designer, your job is to be the voice of those novices in the room.

• CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

A faculty partner gives you a syllabus with 12 dense readings in week one and says "students should figure out the key themes themselves." As a learning designer, your first concern is:

A The readings may be too long for the time available

B Novice learners need structure and explicit connections, not open-ended discovery this early

↑ Back To Top

Design Models

Top



Course Outline

Higher Ed and TLL

2.1 Know TLL

2.2 Introduction to Learning Theories

2.3 How Learning Works

2.4 Introduction to Design Models

T127 as a Practicum

Project Direction

Portfolio Planning

2.4 Introduction to Design Models

ACTIVITY 2 • 15 MIN

How Learning Works

Part 3 of 3: Design Models

LEARNING THEORY
Explains **why** people learn

→
INFORMS

DESIGN MODEL
Describes **how** designers work

Bottom

Course Outline

Higher Ed and TLL

2.1 Know TLL

2.2 Introduction to Learning Theories

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T127 as a Practicum

Project Direction

Portfolio Planning

Looking ahead to T127

LEARNING

WORK

Two models appear constantly in T127: **ADDIE** and **Backwards Design**. Think of them as thinking frameworks, not rigid checklists. You will use both.

DESIGN MODEL
ADDIE

DESIGN MODEL
Backwards Design

Bringing theory and model together

• **CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING**

Using Backwards Design, what should a learning designer determine first when starting a new project?

A Which platform or technology will be used to deliver the content

Portfolio Planning

Top

This screenshot shows the 'Top' view of the '5.1 Portfolio Planning' course page. The header includes the Harvard Graduate School of Education logo and a hamburger menu icon. A sidebar on the left contains a 'Course Outline' with a close button and a list of topics: '2.3 How Learning Works', '2.4 Introduction to Design Models', 'T127 as a Practicum', 'Project Direction', 'Portfolio Planning' (selected), '5.2 Check for Understanding', and '5.3 Portfolio Platform'. The main content area features a red header for '5.1 Portfolio Planning' and a red box titled 'Your Portfolio' with the subtitle 'What it is and how to build it'. Below this, a text box explains that the portfolio is a professional artifact documenting growth as a learning designer. At the bottom, there are three icons: a folder, a target, and a globe.

HARVARD GRADUATE SCHOOL OF EDUCATION

Course Outline X

5.1 Portfolio Planning

PORTFOLIO PLANNING

Your Portfolio

What it is and how to build it

Your portfolio is one of the most important things you will build in T127. It is not just a course requirement. It is a professional artifact that documents your growth as a learning designer and tells your story to future employers, colleagues, and collaborators.

Folder icon, Target icon, Globe icon

Bottom

This screenshot shows the 'Bottom' view of the '5.1 Portfolio Planning' course page. The header and sidebar are identical to the 'Top' view. The main content area displays three text boxes with advice on portfolio building: 'you throughout T127. It is not assembled at the end. Add to it continuously as you work.', 'how you think, not just what you produced. Reflections matter as much as artifacts.', and 'employers, and yourself. Build it with all three in mind from day one.' Below these is a video player with a large red play button and the title 'Your Portfolio'. The video player shows a cartoon illustration of a desk with books, a magnifying glass, and a laptop. The video progress bar at the bottom indicates 0:00 / 4:41.

HARVARD GRADUATE SCHOOL OF EDUCATION

Course Outline X

2.3 How Learning Works

2.4 Introduction to Design Models

T127 as a Practicum

Project Direction

Portfolio Planning

5.1 Portfolio Planning

5.2 Check for Understanding

5.3 Portfolio Platform

you throughout T127. It is not assembled at the end. Add to it continuously as you work.

how you think, not just what you produced. Reflections matter as much as artifacts.

employers, and yourself. Build it with all three in mind from day one.

Your Portfolio

0:00 / 4:41

Check for Understanding



Course Outline



2.3 How Learning Works

2.4 Introduction to Design Models

T127 as a Practicum



Project Direction



○ Portfolio Planning



5.1 Portfolio Planning

● 5.2 Check for Understanding

5.3 Portfolio Platform

Looking ahead to T127



MODULE 2 · PORTFOLIO PLANNING

Check Your Thinking

Agree or disagree with each statement, then reveal what the research says

Before we go further, let us see where your instincts are. For each statement below, move the slider to show whether you agree or disagree, then reveal what T127 actually says.

"A portfolio is just a place to store finished work that I am proud of."

DisagreeAgree



Reveal

"A portfolio reflection is basically a summary of what I did."

DisagreeAgree



Portfolio Platform

Course Outline ×

2.3 How Learning Works

2.4 Introduction to Design Models

T127 as a Practicum

Project Direction

○ Portfolio Planning

5.1 Portfolio Planning

5.2 Check for Understanding

● 5.3 Portfolio Platform

Looking ahead to T127

MODULE 2 · PORTFOLIO PLANNING

Find Your Platform

Answer two questions to find the best platform for you

There is no required platform for your T127 portfolio. But the choice still matters. Answer two quick questions and we will point you toward the option that suits you best.

How comfortable are you building things on the web?

- ☐ A Not very. I prefer to keep things simple and familiar.
- ☐ B Somewhat. I can figure things out with a bit of guidance.
- ☐ C Very comfortable. I enjoy building and customizing things online.

Where things stand currently

- **What is complete**

- Know the TLL, myth and reality flip cards
- How Learning Works, learning theories, novice to expert, and design models
- Portfolio Planning: Your Portfolio page with video placeholder replaced
- Visual identity established across all HTML activities: crimson banner, blush background, consistent card styles

- **What is still in progress**

- Visual consistency between HTML activities and H5P pages in the same module
- Exploring whether H5P can replicate the custom interactions without losing the visual identity
- Testing style stability after full SWIFT migration